



Blueprint for users

Spec blueprints for students, professionals, creators, gamers, and AI tinkerers

This chapter aligns laptop specs to different user scenarios (with India-focused budgets). Each blueprint highlights what to prioritize vs. compromise (“spend here, save there”) and provides example spec tiers (Good/Better/Best) for guidance.

Student / First Laptop (Up to ₹40k–₹60k)

For students and first-time buyers, value and reliability are key. Aim for at least an Intel Core i3 (12th/13th Gen) or AMD Ryzen 3/5 CPU – sufficient for everyday productivity tasks. 8 GB RAM minimum is recommended for smooth multitasking, and choose an SSD (256 GB or more) for faster boot-ups and app load times. Don’t settle for a low-res screen; get a Full HD (1920×1080) display, preferably IPS for better viewing angles. Most laptops in this

range are 14–15.6” with integrated graphics (fine for schoolwork and casual use).

Expect around 6–8 hours of battery life on a budget model – enough for a few classes or library sessions. Build quality will be basic (plastic), but look for a decent keyboard and trackpad since you’ll be writing assignments regularly. Also ensure the webcam is at least 720p for clear video in online classes.

- **Spend on:** Adequate RAM and an SSD. If any model still offers 4 GB or a mechanical HDD, avoid it – 8 GB+ and SSD are worth it for performance and longevity.
- **Save on:** Graphics and luxury extras. Integrated graphics suffice for studies, and you can skip premium materials or ultra-slim designs if a slightly thicker laptop offers better specs at the same price.